



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2026 Version B for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05780) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2026**

Courses Audience: **40**

Responses Received: **38**

Response Ratio: **95.0 %**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Friday, July 3, 2026**

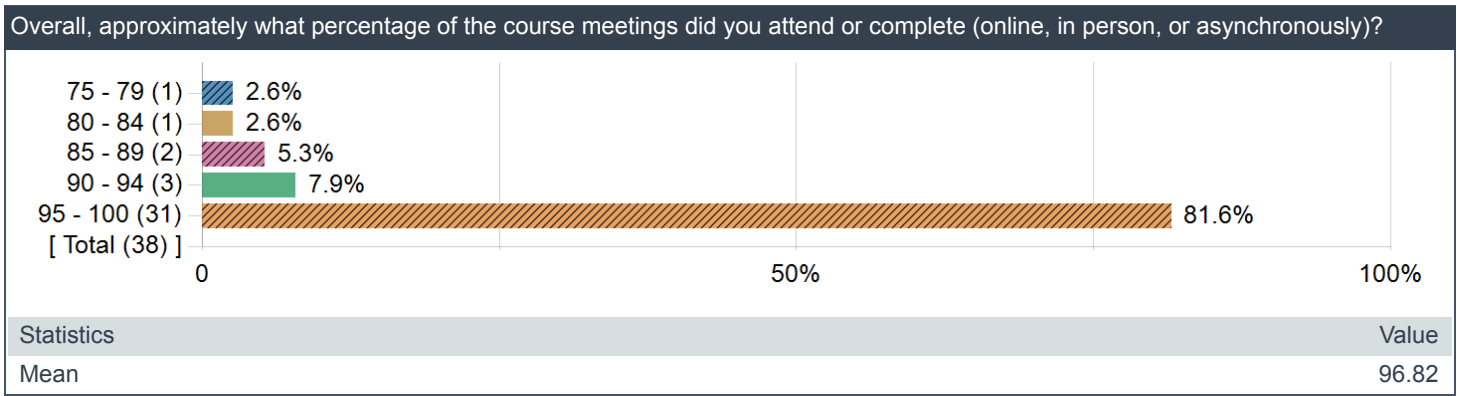
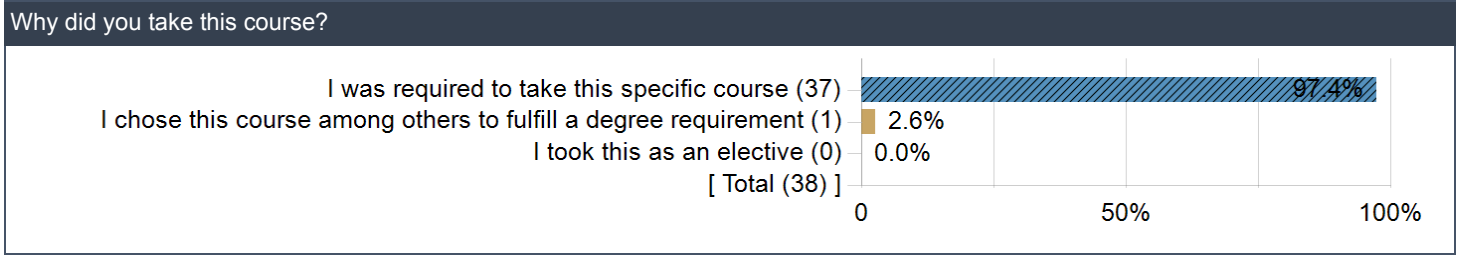
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	52.6%	39.5%	7.9%	0.0%	0.0%	38	4.45
The course was well organized.	44.7%	39.5%	13.2%	2.6%	0.0%	38	4.26
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	57.9%	39.5%	2.6%	0.0%	0.0%	38	4.55
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	63.2%	36.8%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	38	4.63
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	57.9%	36.8%	5.3%	0.0%	0.0%	38	4.53
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	52.6%	42.1%	2.6%	2.6%	0.0%	38	4.45
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	57.9%	34.2%	5.3%	2.6%	0.0%	38	4.47

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	63.2%	36.8%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	38	4.63
Overall, this course was	44.7%	34.2%	21.1%	0.0%	0.0%	38	4.24

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

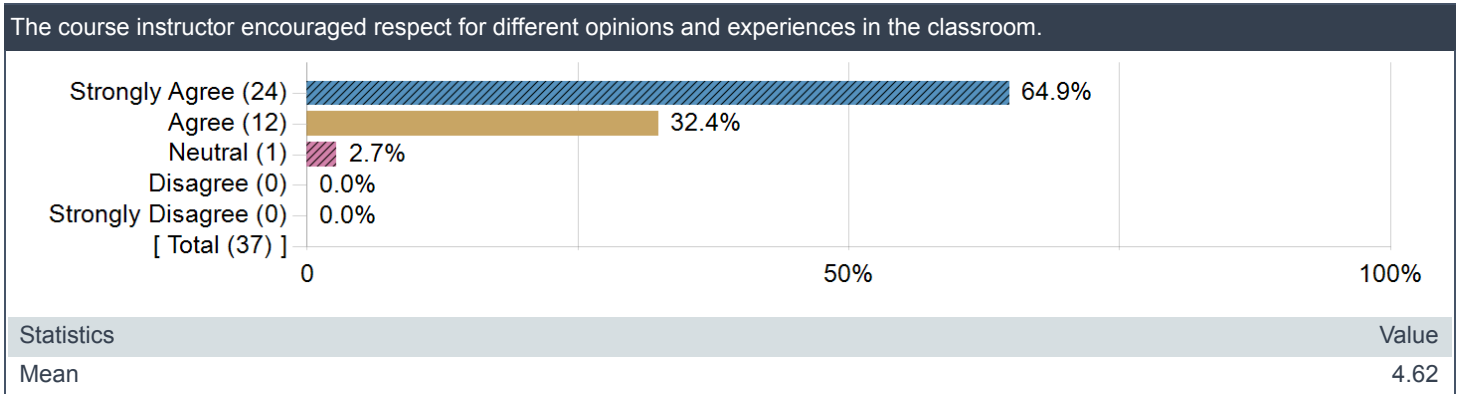
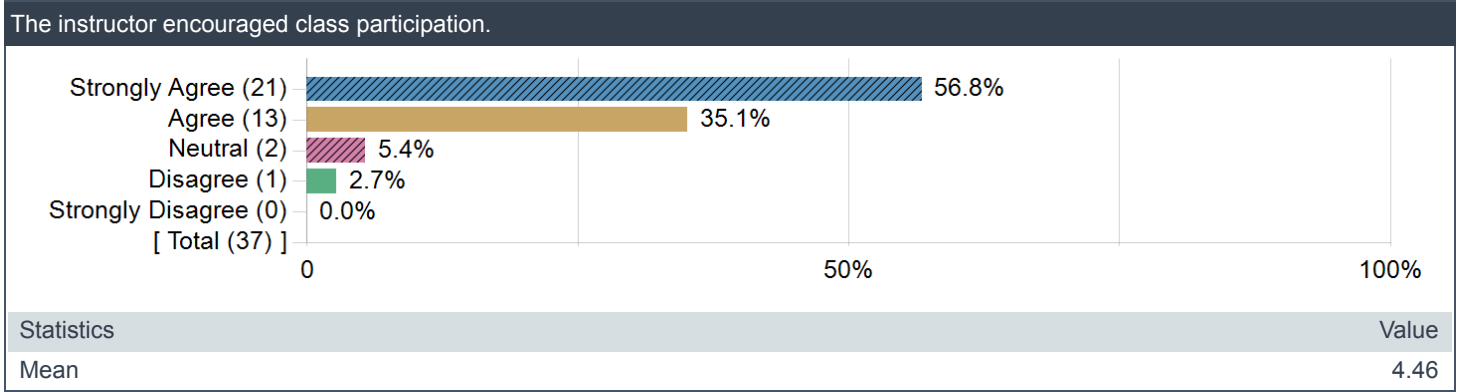
Comments
Bolfarine is a great professor – engaging, funny, and knows material very well. He made the class feel simple and accessible despite its complexity. I got the most value from his in class examples and walk-throughs which kept me engaged and learning hands-on.
Bolfarine walked his students through the challenging quizzes and seemed to really care about his students.
I think him doing the coding step by step with you instead of just saying it verbally
The in-class lectures with notes being actively taken on screen were very helpful with learning the material. Doing practice models with datasets in-class were also helpful.
Homeworks for sure
Live session of running through R
The weekly quizzes helped me shape and test my understanding of each unit. I also enjoyed the professor's humor and style of teaching. It was very easy to understand.
The weekly quizzes forced me to retain learning from the lecture and homework practice
I think the weekly homeworks
funny professor make it two classes instead of one
I love Bolfarine, he was incredibly engaging and funny. He made it super enjoyable, especially for an 8am class.
He was very approachable and friendly.
lectures
Class was very well organized. Largely left us alone in note-taking. You were very helpful with the in-class quizzes, giving us enough help to make informed guesses while still making us work for it. Office hours, even though I didn't use them too much, were available, and email responses were prompt. Overall, just a nice solid class.
Perusall was effective in helping me learn.
Office hour review
I liked how there were many practice problems and opportunities to review the material (eg recordings and labs)
Homeworks / slides
the lectures
The way professor Bolfarine walks through all steps was very helpful in learning the material.
He went over lectures and quizzed us.
the r-scripts that were posted were very helpful
good teaching
I liked the quizzes that help ensure understanding along the way.
The professor explained the class practices really well and it paired well with homework practice.
I enjoyed how well-organized the material in the course was and how Professor Bolfarine made sure to record lectures and labs to help give us future access to material. I think that Professor Bolfarine did a great job of providing all opportunity for access and material throughout the course.
I think the examples in class were very helpful for my learning. He did a great job explaining what he was doing as he went
It was helpful having in class R-studio practice.
In class lectures as well as the homeworks
The homework and practice exams being similar to actual exams were effective. Moreover the structured R walkthrough was helpful.
Professor Bolfarine made the lectures entertaining and easy to understand, especially at 8am. You can tell he truly cares.
the weekly quizzes were good gauges as well as the homework's.
Good teacher

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
I think he did everything fantastically.
The wording on the exams was difficult to understand exactly what it was asking you.
The coding it's self
Lectures and quizzes were difficult and non engaging partly because periods were so long
Some of the questions on the test were a bit confusing and not talked about a ton during class —> maybe making a study guide with the useful information needed for tests
The hardest part was the coding as I hadn't taken STA301 since last year. But the professor was very helpful in refamiliarizing myself with this.
The content itself is very confusing and notes we take in class together are sometimes unclear
I found the weekly quiz at 8 am to be pretty challenging
super hard class for only a two hour credit
More practice in class that relates to the exam, either beginning with conceptual questions, etc.
I had a hard time with the midterm.
being able to get a good grade on the daily lockdown quizzes. impacted my grade pretty negatively.
Did I understand the material? Yeah for the most part, but popping more questions during lecture would help a lot. It felt kinda boring when you'd just start going off and not really stopping. Maybe ask a couple of questions about what we think the next step should be, or to summarize/explain what we just did would help. Even if we don't answer, it'll keep us on our toes and force us to be trying more to understand the material in class.
I found the quizzes to be very challenging. One thing I could do better would be to go to office hours more often.
Quiz/exam wording
I wish the class had a longer/more in depth review of sta 301 and the basics of R
Quizzes
the tests
The course is very material heavy and that's the most challenging aspect of the course. I'm not sure what can be done to help besides more access to help outside of class.
The weekly quizzes.
the tests had short answer questions types that were not present in other types of assignments, they weren't harder just sometimes I wasn't sure how to answer them
Bad environment (in a basement at 8am is irritating to pay attention in)
I also thought the quizzes were challenging but helped engagement with the material. I think it is important to come prepared to class.
Quizzes can sometimes be hard, maybe make them more collaborative in the future?
I think that this course being taught in R-studio is very unnecessary. Specifically, within the finance and business world, R-studio is rarely (if ever) used for statistical analysis and learning it in this platform puts students at a disadvantage as there is no practical application. This course should be taught in a standard business/finance application such as excel, that is widely used and applicable in their jobs and internships. Further, this class either needs to be changed to a 3-hour course or the material needs to be reduced, as almost every class period we were going 10–15 minutes over our time and still not getting through all the material that we were supposed to cover for the day. This feels like it is not respectful to the student's time or the professors for having to rush through class and hold students longer than they are supposed to, resulting in being late to other classes or obligations.
I think some of the quizzes and homeworks were a little challenging and some used code that we had never really talked about or used.
It was very difficult to teach myself course content before we learned it in class and it was difficult to use R-studio it would've been better to learn how to use excel.
N/A
I believe the professor could do a better job of being prepared – while he knows the content, at 8 AM he was very much getting to the point of rambling, not being concise, and overall having trouble figuring out the proper order of words for the R script/interpretation. If he can do the script before his first lecture, his results would show a lot more concision, preparation, and lead to more efficient outcomes.
The quizzes every class are really challenging and I found myself struggling on them. The fact that they're weighted so much doesn't help. I also think that the tests were really challenging and I wish they would drop more grades.

Comments
The weekly perusals were not helpful and often times I just rushed through them as the slides were much more effective for my learning and more concise.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

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